

Mental stop A stop-loss order kept in your head instead of being placed with a broker. Day traders, for example, may use a mental stop and sell when the time is right instead of letting a hard stop force an exit. Contrast with *Hard stop*.

Minor high A price peak usually separated from other peaks by at least 5 price bars. Points 3 and 4 in [Figure G2](#) are minor highs.

Minor low A price valley usually separated from other valleys by at least 5 price bars. Points 1 and 2 in [Figure G2](#) are minor lows.

Narrow pattern Measured from the chart pattern's start to end, this is the pattern's width, in calendar days. Patterns longer than the median length are wide; shorter than the median are narrow. See [Table x.5](#).

Neckline A trendline joining the armpits of a head-and-shoulders pattern. A close below/above the neckline signals a breakout from the chart pattern.

Overshoot Price sometimes overshoots the top of the pattern within two weeks before entering a chart pattern. Overshoots are not included in the calculation of the trend start. [Figure G4](#) shows an example overshoot at F. Price forms a symmetrical triangle (E) and price rises into the chart pattern from the low at D. At F, price overshoots the start of the triangle, which could interfere with the determination of where the trend starts.

Partial decline After price touches a top trendline, price declines but does not touch (or come that close to) a lower trendline before forming a distinct minor low and usually staging an immediate upward breakout. Partial declines must begin before the actual breakout and form after a valid chart pattern appears (after the chart pattern meets all identification guidelines). See [Figure G2](#).